mentioned in chapter 4, and a complete reference to the C++11 Thread Library.

Who should read this book

If you're writing multithreaded code in C++, you should read this book. If you're using the new multithreading facilities from the C++ Standard Library, this book is an essential guide. If you're using alternative thread libraries, the guidelines and techniques from the later chapters should still prove useful.

A good working knowledge of C++ is assumed, though familiarity with the new language features is not—these are covered in appendix A. Prior knowledge or experience of multithreaded programming is not assumed, though it may be useful.

How to use this book

If you've never written multithreaded code before, I suggest reading this book sequentially from beginning to end, though possibly skipping the more detailed parts of chapter 5. Chapter 7 relies heavily on the material in chapter 5, so if you skipped chapter 5, you should save chapter 7 until you've read it.

If you've not used the new C++11 language facilities before, it might be worth skimming appendix A before you start to ensure that you're up to speed with the examples in the book. The uses of the new language facilities are highlighted in the text, though, and you can always flip to the appendix if you encounter something you've not seen before.

If you have extensive experience with writing multithreaded code in other environments, the beginning chapters are probably still worth skimming so you can see how the facilities you know map onto the new standard C++ ones. If you're going to be doing any low-level work with atomic variables, chapter 5 is a must. Chapter 8 is worth reviewing to ensure that you're